THE GENERIC BREAKTHROUGH

Pharmacy to the World

India's pharmaceutical industry has evolved from dependency on foreign firms to global dominance. Driven by generics, biopharma breakthroughs and innovation, it has cemented the country's status as the planet's drug factory

BY M.G. ARUN

The story of the rise of the Indian pharmaceutical industry may not have garnered as much global attention as India's IT and outsourcing boom, but it's equally fascinating. From being an industry dominated by foreign pharmaceutical companies at the time of Independence in 1947, Indian drug manufacturers have flourished not just to dominate the domestic markets, but to have a major presence in the high-value US and European markets too.

Foreign drug firms protected their proprietary drugs from copycats using patent laws, but with the passing of the Patents Act, 1970, they could no

> "India is not just contributing to the arena of medicines but also playing a humanitarian role by manufacturing medicines and supplying them at a low cost across the world"
>
> **— Y.K. HAMIED**
> *Non-Executive Chairman, Cipla, and one of the Indian business leaders who took on Big Pharma of the West, in a bid to break their monopoly*



SOUMIK KAR